

Word family: **promote / promotes / promoted / promoting / promotion / promotional / promoter**

Base word: promote

Forms: promotes, promoted, promoting

Related forms: promotion, promotional, promoter

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / related nouns and adjective (相關名詞及形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “Moreover, this habit damages the wider social environment and **promotes the wrong values**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **promote** means **to encourage, support, or help a particular idea, value, behaviour, or tendency to develop and become more widespread**.

The writer means that using restaurants this way may encourage attitudes such as putting personal convenience above consideration for other people.

繁體中文： **助長；鼓勵；提倡；促進某種觀念、價值觀或行為的形成和傳播**

中文翻譯：

> “...and **promotes the wrong values**.”

「.....並且**助長 / 鼓吹不恰當的價值觀**。」

Here:

promote values = 鼓勵、強化並傳播某些價值觀，使它們更容易被接受或實踐

1. **promote = encourage or support an idea, activity, behaviour, cause, etc. (提倡 / 促進) — 促進；提倡；推動；助長**

This is the **exact passage sense**.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The habit may **promote** the wrong values.”

「這種習慣可能會**助長 / 鼓吹**不恰當的價值觀。」

Practice 2

> “Schools should ****promote**** respect for others.”

「學校應該****提倡****尊重他人。」

Practice 3

> “The programme aims to ****promote**** healthy eating.”

「這項計劃旨在****推廣 / 促進****健康飲食。」

****promote = 幫助某種思想、行為、活動、目標或價值發展、受到支持或變得更普遍****

Common:

- * promote equality
- * promote cooperation
- * promote awareness
- * promote healthy habits
- * promote social responsibility
- * promote economic development
- * promote peace

Importantly, the result need not be positive:

- > promote violence
- > promote unhealthy behaviour
- > promote misinformation

So ****promote**** itself is neutral; the object determines whether the outcome is desirable.

2. ****promote = help something develop, grow, improve, or happen (發展) — 促進 ; 增進****

This is closely related to #1 but often applies to a process rather than an idea or cause.

Practice 4

> “Regular exercise can ****promote**** good health.”

「恆常運動可以****促進****健康。」

Practice 5

> “The treatment may ****promote**** healing.”

「這種治療可能有助**促進癒合**。」

Practice 6

> “The policy was designed to **promote** competition.”

「這項政策旨在**促進**競爭。」

Common:

- * promote growth
- * promote healing
- * promote development
- * promote learning
- * promote recovery
- * promote trade

The underlying concept remains:

> **make something more likely to develop or progress**

For strict counting, I would merge #1 and #2.

3. **promote = advertise/publicize something so more people will buy, attend, or notice it (宣傳) — 推廣 ; 宣傳 ; 促銷**

A major distinct meaning.

Practice 7

> “The company is **promoting** its new product online.”

「公司正在網上**推廣 / 宣傳**新產品。」

Practice 8

> “They used social media to **promote** the concert.”

「他們利用社交媒體**宣傳**音樂會。」

Practice 9

> “The campaign **promotes** Hong Kong as a travel destination.”

「這項宣傳活動把香港**推廣為**旅遊目的地。」

promote = 透過廣告、宣傳、媒體曝光等方式提高某項產品、服務、活動或人物的知名度 / 吸引力

Common:

- * promote a product
- * promote a brand
- * promote an event
- * promote a film
- * promote a business
- * promote something on social media

This is **not** the meaning in your passage.

4. **promote someone = move them to a higher job, rank, or position (職位) — 晉升 ; 升職**

Another major distinct sense.

Practice 10

> “She was **promoted** to manager.”

「她被**晉升為**經理。」

Practice 11

> “The company **promoted** him after two successful years.”

「公司在他表現出色兩年後把他**升職**。」

promote someone = 給某人較高的職位、職級、軍階或責任

Common construction:

> **promote someone to + rank/job**

> promoted to director

> promoted to captain

5. **promotion = advancement to a higher job/rank (名詞) — 晉升 ; 升職**

Practice 12

> “She received a **promotion** last month.”

「她上個月獲得**升職 / 晉升**。」

Practice 13

> “He is hoping for a **promotion**.”

「他希望獲得**晉升**。」

This is the noun counterpart of Meaning 4.

6. **promote = move a student/person/team to a higher level or division (級別) — 升級 ; 升班 ; 晉級**

The advancement sense extends beyond employment.

Education

Practice 14

> “Students who meet the requirements are **promoted** to the next grade.”

「達到要求的學生會**升讀下一級 / 升班**。」

This use is especially familiar in some education systems and varieties of English.

Sport

Practice 15

> “The club was **promoted** to the top division.”

「該球會**升上頂級聯賽**。」

promote = 令某人 / 隊伍由較低級別進入較高級別

For core counting, this can be merged with the broader advancement sense in #4.

7. **promotion = movement to a higher sports division (體育) — 升班；升級**

Practice 16

> “The team secured **promotion** after winning the final match.”

「球隊贏得最後一場比賽後成功取得**升班資格**。」

Opposite:

> **relegation**

= 降班

This is a very important sports collocation.

8. **promote = advance something to a higher status or role (抽象 / 技術) — 提升；升格**

The same higher-rank idea can apply to things as well as people.

Practice 17

> “The issue was **promoted** to a higher priority.”

「這個問題被**提升至更高優先級**。」

In computing/system administration, a server, database replica, or account can sometimes be **promoted** to a higher or primary role.

Example:

> “The replica was promoted to primary.”

「該副本被**提升為主要節點**。」

This is a genuine technical extension of:

> **move to higher status**

rather than a new core meaning.

9. **pawn promotion / promote a pawn (棋類) — 兵升變**

In chess, when a pawn reaches the farthest rank, it is ****promoted**** to another piece, normally a queen, rook, bishop, or knight.

Practice 18

> “She ****promoted**** the pawn to a queen.”

「她把兵****升變為后****。」

Practice 19

> “Pawn ****promotion**** changed the game.”

「兵的****升變****改變了局勢。」

This is a genuine specialist use of the higher-status/change-of-role branch.

10. ****promote** = stimulate a chemical/biological process (科學) — 促進 ; 催進******

Scientific writing may use ****promote**** when something enhances a reaction or biological process.

Practice 20

> “The compound ****promotes**** cell growth.”

「這種化合物會****促進細胞生長****。」

Practice 21

> “The catalyst ****promotes**** the reaction.”

「這種催化劑有助****促進反應****。」

This belongs to the broad ****cause development/process to occur more readily**** sense.

Related form: ****promotion****

****Promotion**** has several highly important meanings of its own.

1. ****advancement in rank/job****

> get a promotion

= **升職 / 晉升**

2. **advertising/publicity**

> product promotion

= **產品推廣 / 宣傳**

3. **special sales offer/campaign**

> “The supermarket is running a promotion.”

「超級市場正在進行一項**促銷活動 / 優惠活動**。」

Here a **promotion** can mean a temporary marketing offer such as:

* discount

* special deal

* free gift

* buy-one-get-one offer

This is extremely common in retail.

Practice 22

> “The restaurant is offering a lunch **promotion**.”

「餐廳正在推出午市**優惠 / 促銷活動**。」

This family sense is important because:

> **promotion = promotion at work**

and

> **promotion = sales campaign**

can be completely different.

Related form: **promotional**

Promotional usually means intended to advertise or increase sales/awareness.

Practice 23

> “The company produced a **promotional** video.”

「公司製作了一段**宣傳影片**。」

Practice 24

> “Customers received **promotional** offers by email.”

「顧客透過電郵收到**促銷優惠**。」

Common:

- * promotional material
- * promotional campaign
- * promotional offer
- * promotional event
- * promotional video

This primarily belongs to the advertising branch.

Related form: **promoter**

Promoter has several useful meanings.

**promoter = person who actively supports a cause/idea (倡導者) **

> “She is a strong promoter of reading.”

「她是閱讀的積極**推動者 / 倡導者**。」

**promoter = person/company arranging and publicizing events (活動主辦 / 推廣者) **

Especially entertainment and sport:

- > concert promoter
- > boxing promoter

Practice 25

> “The concert **promoter** announced a second show.”

「演唱會**主辦 / 推廣公司**宣布加開第二場。」

promoter = DNA regulatory region (遺傳學) — 啟動子

In molecular biology, a **promoter** is a DNA region associated with initiating transcription of a gene.

繁體中文： 啟動子

This is a genuine and important scientific family sense, but it is **not a meaning of bare `promote`** in everyday English.

promoter = substance enhancing catalyst activity (化學) — 促進劑

In chemistry/catalysis, a **promoter** can be a substance that enhances the activity, selectivity, or stability of a catalyst.

繁體中文： 助催化劑 / 促進劑

Again, specialist family vocabulary.

Related idea: **self-promotion**

Self-promotion means deliberately drawing attention to your own abilities, achievements, work, or public image.

Practice 26

> “Social media makes self-**promotion** easier.”

「社交媒體令**自我宣傳**更加容易。」

Depending on context, the phrase can be neutral or mildly critical.

Important distinction: **promote** vs **encourage**

encourage

often focuses on giving someone support or making an action more likely.

promote

often sounds broader and more systematic:

- > encourage students to read
- > promote reading in the community

So **promote** can imply creating conditions for a practice or value to spread.

Important distinction: **promote vs support**

support

means help, approve, or provide resources.

promote

goes further when it means actively helping something **develop, spread, or gain acceptance**.

- > support a campaign
- > promote a campaign

The second often implies active advocacy/publicity.

Important distinction: **promote vs foster**

foster

means encourage gradual development.

promote

can mean encourage development but is broader and also covers advertising and promotion in rank.

- > foster creativity
- > promote creativity

Very close in this sense.

Important distinction: ****promote vs advertise****

****advertise****

specifically involves paid or deliberate publicity to attract customers/audience.

****promote****

is broader:

- > advertise a product
- > promote a product

But also:

- > promote cooperation

where ****advertise**** is impossible.

So:

****advertising is one way of promoting something.****

Important distinction: ****promote vs publicize****

****publicize****

means make something widely known.

****promote****

usually adds the aim of increasing:

- * support
- * sales
- * attendance
- * popularity
- * acceptance

- > publicize an event

> promote an event

The latter is more explicitly persuasive.

Important distinction: ****promote vs market****

****market****

means plan and carry out commercial activities to sell a product/service.

****promote****

is one component of marketing and focuses more directly on publicity/awareness.

A company may:

> market a product through pricing, distribution, branding, and promotion.

Important distinction: ****promote vs advance — career****

****promote someone****

= give that person a higher rank/job.

****advance****

can mean make progress more generally.

> “She was promoted to manager.”

is much more natural than:

> “She was advanced to manager.”

in ordinary employment English.

Important distinction: ****promote vs raise****

****raise****

usually means increase a level/amount or physically lift something.

promote

means move someone/something to higher status or actively encourage development.

- > raise salaries
- > promote an employee

Important distinction: **promote vs advocate**

advocate

means publicly argue in favour of a particular idea or policy.

promote

can include advocacy but also includes practical actions that help the idea spread.

- > advocate healthier eating
- > promote healthier eating

The second can include campaigns, education, incentives, etc.

Grammar note: **promote + thing**

For encouragement/advertising:

- > promote healthy eating
- > promote a product
- > promote awareness
- > promote tourism

Grammar note: **promote someone to + position/rank**

- > promote her to manager
- > promote him to captain

Not normally:

> “promote her as manager” ❌

for the act of giving the promotion.

However:

> **promote someone as X**

can mean **publicize/present them as X**:

> “The campaign promoted him as an expert.”

= 宣傳 / 塑造他為專家。

That is the advertising/presentation sense, not the career sense.

Grammar note: **be promoted from A to B**

> “She was promoted from assistant manager to manager.”

「她由助理經理**晉升為**經理。」

Grammar note: **promote something as something**

Advertising/presentation

> “The town is promoted as a cultural destination.”

「這個小鎮被**推廣為**文化旅遊目的地。」

This means:

> present/publicize it in that identity.

Countability note

Promote is a verb.

Promotion is countable in many contexts:

Career

- > a promotion
- > two promotions

Marketing campaign

- > a promotion
- > several promotions

But the general activity of advertising can also be uncountable:

- > product promotion
- > tourism promotion

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **promote**
- * **promotes**
- * **promoted**
- * **promoting**
- * **promotion**
- * **promotional**
- * **promoter**

Useful compounds/constructions include:

- * promote awareness
- * promote development
- * promote healthy behaviour
- * promote a product
- * promote an event
- * promote someone to manager
- * be promoted from A to B
- * sports promotion
- * sales promotion
- * promotional offer
- * self-promotion

A full family sweep also reveals important specialist branches:

- * **pawn promotion** — chess

* **promote a replica/server to primary** — computing
 * **promoter** — genetics: gene regulatory DNA region
 * **promoter** — chemistry: catalyst-enhancing substance

Those should be surfaced but not confused with the everyday base-verb meanings.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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promote — idea/value/activity	鼓勵、提倡或幫助某種觀念、行為、目標等發展並變得更普遍
promote — process/development	促進某種成長、健康、學習、癒合、發展等
promote — advertise	透過宣傳提高產品、活動、品牌等的知名度、銷量或吸引力
promote — job/rank	把某人提升到較高職位、職級或軍階；晉升
promote — level/division	令學生、球隊等升到較高級別 / 組別
promote — technical status	把系統、帳戶、伺服器提升到較高角色 / 狀態
pawn promotion	西洋棋中兵到達底線後升變為較高級棋子
promotion — career	升職 / 晉升
promotion — marketing	宣傳 / 推廣活動；亦可指促銷優惠
promotional	以宣傳、推廣或促銷為目的的
promoter — advocate/event	推動某理念的人；或活動 / 演出的主辦推廣者
promoter — genetics	啟動基因轉錄的 DNA 區域；啟動子
promoter — chemistry	提升催化劑效能的助催化劑 / 促進劑

For your original sentence

> “...this habit damages the wider social environment and **promotes the wrong values**.”

The exact meaning is:

promote = 令某些價值觀受到鼓勵、強化並更容易被人接受或模仿

So:

> **promote the wrong values**

= **助長 / 鼓吹不恰當的價值觀**

It does **not** mean:

> advertise the values

in the commercial sense, although both meanings contain the broader idea of helping something become more visible or widespread.

For your database, I would count **4** genuinely useful core meanings for **promote**:

1. **encourage/support the development or spread of an idea, behaviour, condition, or process**
2. **advertise/publicize a product, service, event, person, or place**
3. **raise someone to a higher job, rank, or position**
4. **advance someone/something to a higher level, division, or status**

I would merge health/growth/healing uses into #1, education/sports advancement closely with #3/#4, and preserve **promotion / promotional / promoter** because the family develops several highly useful independent meanings, especially **sales promotion**, **event promoter**, and scientific **gene promoter**.